

Chapter 172-3

//

Liang Shi didn't pay much attention to the online comments, even though the public opinion kept fermenting.

By the time she finished filming *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo*, the comments about her still hadn't died down.

Labels like "resource mooch" and "marketing personality" were all placed on her.

Even her previous red dress look trending was said to have been deliberate.

Most critically, when people searched for her online, they couldn't find anything—just a few ambiguous exposés with no substantial content.

Nothing more than claims that she used to have a bad personality, her family had some money, but now she'd fallen on hard times—the whole "fallen heiress" script.

Liang Shi was actually quite surprised that the things the original owner had done before hadn't been dug up.

According to her speculation, they should have been dragged out during this wave of negative press to muddy the waters. It wasn't until she received a private message that she discovered it was Liang Xinzhou's doing.

Because Liang Shi had told him before that she didn't want people to know about her identity as the Liang family's Third Miss when entering the entertainment industry, and she didn't want those past incidents to be exposed, Liang Xinzhou had handled all of it for her.

He had even erased her connection to Dongheng.

When capital entered the arena, nothing survived.

After learning this, Liang Shi sent Liang Xinzhou a message: [Thank you, Big Brother.]

With Yu Wan's due date approaching, after *Mo Mo Mo Mo Mo* wrapped, Liang Shi went with Xu Qingzhu to visit Yu Wan at the hospital. At that time, Yu Wan was watching Gu Yixue's viral movie *"Rose Heart Fire,"* watching with great interest.

Since she had nothing to do recently, she had started her internet surfing life at the hospital. She knew Liang Shi had acted in Gu Yixue's new movie, which was about to be released.

Liang Shi sat there peeling an apple for Yu Wan, and Yu Wan asked her, "Is Quella really that beautiful? Is she more beautiful in person or in photos?"

"In person," Liang Shi said. "She could play the female lead and it wouldn't break immersion at all."

"That's really impressive," Yu Wan said. "I've long heard that the Gu family's daughter is a rare figure among Betas, but I've never met her."

"I'll introduce you someday," Liang Shi said with a light laugh.

"You two are that close?" Yu Wan paused, then laughed. "Well, that makes sense. After all, you're the kind of people who would crash a wedding together."

Liang Shi: "....."

That incident had probably spread throughout high society circles.

Who knows how long Gu Yixue had been the subject of after-dinner gossip.

But the storm over that matter had passed.

Recently, she heard that Gu Yixue was planning to shoot a new movie—apparently a period martial arts film. Another brand new challenge.

Liang Shi chatted with Yu Wan for a while, then Sun Meirou arrived with Ling Dang.

Ling Dang looked dejected. Liang Shi thought she was unhappy because school had started and asked what was wrong.

Ling Dang pouted. "Zhou Caihong is so disloyal. She just transferred schools like that. How outrageous!"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi coaxed Ling Dang for a while.

Xu Qingzhu had only come in her spare time. She occasionally chimed in during their conversation, but before long she started feeling drowsy. Her body also made it difficult for her to sit for too long, so they didn't stay long before leaving the hospital.

Before leaving, Xu Qingzhu happened to run into Liang Xinzhou, who had just rushed over from the company, and they chatted briefly.

Calling it a chat, it was more like a complaint, or even a warning.

"You know who's behind all that stuff online, right?" Xu Qingzhu said. "Right now, like Liang Shi, I can still tolerate it. But if this continues, I really won't be polite."

"How do you plan to be impolite?" Liang Xinzhou asked with a smile.

Xu Qingzhu frowned. "Does Big Brother think I'm joking?"

Liang Xinzhou shook his head. "That someone can protect A-Shi like this—I think that's very good."

Xu Qingzhu was immediately mollified by his words, but she still said, "I don't know what I might do, but I'll give her a taste of her own medicine. Everyone now knows she's the long-lost miss of Dongheng Group, so her every word and action currently represents Dongheng. Big Brother, you know A-Shi has always respected you. I also don't want to make things difficult for you."

Liang Xinzhou nodded. "Don't worry about me or Dongheng. I have my own ways of dealing with things."

"You... won't stop it?" Xu Qingzhu furrowed her brows slightly.

She had thought that after telling Liang Xinzhou, he would stop it at the source.

But Liang Xinzhou shook his head. "She represents Dongheng? She doesn't have that qualification yet. Do you remember what happened with Ling Dang before? I still have some doubts, so I need to wait for her to do something before I can find evidence. If you walk by the river often enough, how can you not get your shoes wet?"¹

Xu Qingzhu was momentarily stunned, then after a long while smiled helplessly. "Alright then."

Liang Xinzhou didn't let her act recklessly either, but rather told her to be careful and cautious. "If it really is her doing, you don't need to be polite, and you don't need to worry about me. But if it hasn't been confirmed yet that she did it, I hope you'll show some mercy. Wan'er is about to give birth, and Xinhe isn't someone who can handle pressure, so..."

He didn't finish the rest, but he was asking Xu Qingzhu to leave some face.

But Xu Qingzhu just smiled gracefully. "Big Brother, am I really that capable? It won't go that far."

"I would never underestimate anyone from the Sheng family." Liang Xinzhou shrugged. "Especially someone who could bring Minghui back from the dead in half a year. Qingzhu, you really are very capable."

Xu Qingzhu was unexpectedly praised and quite pleased. "Suddenly I feel full of motivation."

Liang Xinzhou laughed softly. "Qingzhu, A-Shi has a bit of a childish nature, but she's a good person. The Liang family's matters are the Liang family's—they have nothing to do with her personally. Live your lives well and don't let these things affect you."

"She might not have been very good before, perhaps because my mother twisted her personality. But now that she's with you, she's really, truly good. I can always see traces of her childhood self in her." Liang Xinzhou's voice was softer than ever. He turned to look at Xu Qingzhu. "If she does anything wrong, come tell me and I'll discipline her for you."

Xu Qingzhu heard a feeling of "entrusting an orphan"² in his words.

"What do you mean by this?" Xu Qingzhu asked. "Big Brother, this isn't like you."

"Just treat it as me having had too much to drink." Liang Xinzhou raised his hand to his forehead. "She only has you left now. Take good care of each other."

Xu Qingzhu was startled, then suddenly understood what Liang Xinzhou meant.

Because when it came down to it, Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe were still members of the Liang family—Qiu Zimin's sons. No matter how much they cared for Liang Shi, they couldn't cross Dongheng's bottom line.

During holidays and festivals, there would be no opportunity to be with Liang Shi.

In the end, Liang Shi would be left alone.

So apart from her, Liang Shi had no family.

Yet Liang Xinzhou truly cared for Liang Shi. He hoped Liang Shi would be well, hoped she could still have a home, have someone who loved her.

This coincided with some of Xu Qingzhu's own thoughts.

So Xu Qingzhu took the opportunity to ask Liang Xinzhou, "Then do you know that Liang Shi actually has other family? Where are her birth parents?"

"I've asked my mother and looked into it myself." Liang Xinzhou shook his head. "Couldn't find anything."

Xu Qingzhu tried to detect any trace of lying in his expression but found only sincerity.

He truly didn't know.

Xu Qingzhu also breathed a sigh of relief.

Footnotes:

¹ **"If you walk by the river often enough, how can you not get your shoes wet?"** (常在河邊走，哪有不濕鞋的): A Chinese proverb meaning that if someone keeps doing bad things, they will eventually get caught or face consequences. Similar to "crime doesn't pay" or "if you play with fire, you'll get burned."

² **"Entrusting an orphan"** (托孤): A classical Chinese concept referring to entrusting the care of one's child or loved one to another person, typically done when facing death or permanent separation. It's a very serious and emotional gesture of trust.